BUILDINGS AND GI

The Next Frontier for 'Made in India'

India is at the forefront of a much-needed reversal of local knowledge and resources. A new generation of architects and designers is focusing their practice on making hyperlocal buildings that carry a distinct impression of where they came from and where they are sited. However, the stories behind the structures that define our cities are largely untold.

A building, much like a product, has a provenance that can be made legible. A GI sign on a product identifies the essential qualities of the specific region that imbues it with unique characteristics not found elsewhere. The label on a box of Darjeeling tea is a story of a specific region and the same is true for Roquefort cheese and Cognac. GIs are powerful intangible assets that enable consumers to perceive the value and quality associated with a place instantly. What if this same principle were applied to our buildings?

One can then speculate that an exceptional building, made entirely with local knowledge and materials, can carry the GI sign as a mark of pride? Considering that there is an inextricable link between the Jaisalmer stone and the Patwaon Haveli, it is evident that a building should carry a sign defining its antecedents. By simply marking these buildings and giving them an identity, their design stories, preservation, restoration, and repurposing of the built environment become easier.

The urban experience of Buildings is a visual phenomenon, consumed by our eyes, yet too little is known about how and why they are made. A GI sign on a building conveys its sustainability quotient of using local materials and responding to local climate, and the importance of preserving these structures. When we make a building's origins legible—by labelling provenance, process, and place—we can reward artisans, promote lower-carbon, climate-sensitive design, and help the public "read" cities and buildings with the same literacy we bring to products. This is an innovation from the Global South ready to inspire a worldwide shift in how we see and value the very structures we inhabit.



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THE CREATIVE ODYSSEY OF MOTHER-DAUGHTER DUO, ARTISTS INDRANI AND BABITA SATPATI

Modern India's growth story will be defined by the courage to rebuild. Artists Indrani and Babita Satpati channel the strength of resilience into a powerful cultural dialogue, where every canvas serves as a medium for profound creative expression.

Babita's artistic journey began with a family transition that transformed her into a self-taught contemporary artist. She turned to the canvas to process the complexities of human emotion and spiritual experience. Her work has travelled the local galleries of Kolkata and Delhi to the global stages of World Art Dubai. She utilizes diverse mediums such as charcoal, archival prints, and plywood boards.

Babita's signature 80x30-inch masterpiece, 'Thin Line of Love', meditates on elemental balance. Visualizing Akash (sky) and Jal (water) grounded in Ma Prithvi (the earth), its peach hues symbolize eternal love against deep blues. Her work reflects modern India blending radical mosaic drip art with ancient metaphysics.

Babita's mother, artist Indrani Satpati, an 84-year-old spiritual author and poet, suffered a cerebral attack in the year 2021. Faced with partial paralysis, she did not retreat; instead, she "remade" her world through therapeutic art. Holding a paintbrush for the first time at 84, Indrani began translating her spiritual poetry into visual form. Her paintings - vibrant depictions of flora, fauna, and the sacred Ganges represent the ultimate triumph of the spirit. Indrani has authored three books in Bangla and written over 109 poems.

The mother-daughter duo believes that the nation's true progress is born out of the wisdom to look beyond and the courage to step past.







